

I Feel Like I'm Back at Square One

So maybe you were doing better for a few days or maybe longer, and now you're in a flare or a setback or a wave of symptoms that your brain is telling you is just as bad as when you were at the beginning of all this, and your brain is telling you you've lost all your progress, you're starting over and none of this is working.

And that's where I need to tell you. You are not back at square one, although I know how much it feels like that when you're in the middle of this, when you have a setback or symptoms pop back up. Nothing is resetting. It's, it's not proof of anything, not working. There will be bad days, there will be bad weeks, and it doesn't erase all of the new responses and rewiring and work that has already happened for you.

This is the reality. This is what people don't talk about. This is how recovery and desensitization actually works. It is not linear, and that is not cliché. It does not go in a straight line. You don't just feel better and better and better every single day until you've healed. You will have really good stretches and they will get longer and longer, but you will also have hard stretches, and you'll have times when you kind of loop back into those hard stretches.

And there will be moments where you are like, am I just good at feeling really bad? Has anything actually changed? But the important part that's next is you keep going anyway, because over time the hard stretches get shorter and further apart. The worst thing that you can do, the worst way that you can handle this right now is to panic and, and start over and start looking for something else.

Don't go looking for a new approach. Don't start researching again. Don't abandon what you've been doing because it didn't work. It is working. This is all part of it. If you are putting in the work, responding in a new way. Allowing what's there, accepting what's going on for you. You are doing the work, and this is part of it.

Your only job during these setbacks is to respond the same way you've already been practicing, and if you haven't been practicing your response, that's where you start. Don't react. Don't spiral and don't make this mean something about you or the

progress that you've made. If you need a reminder of what you're experiencing, what I refer to as a recalibration phase, I want you to review lesson six.

If you feel tempted to throw everything out and try something new, go back to lesson two. You're not starting over. You're having a hard moment. We all have so many hard moments on this journey, but it's your job to just keep going.